

Open Educational Resources Policy — Main Policy

Document Type	Main Policy	Reference Record	te-pol-2023-031
Department	Technical Education	Reference	TE/POL/2023/031
Year	2023	Status	Active

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Issued in 2023 by Technical Education under reference TE/POL/2023/031, this main policy establishes the arrangements supporting Open Educational Resources Policy. In scope are OER, Open Resources, Courseware, together with related expectations for institutions and stakeholders.

Background and Scope

Following sustained engagement with universities, colleges and sector bodies, Technical Education has prepared this main policy to give effect to OER, Open Resources. It builds on earlier guidance while updating expectations to reflect current conditions.

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Purpose and Intent

By setting out the rationale, scope and operating expectations for OER, the document aims to reduce ambiguity, support institutional planning and improve the quality of Open Resources across the system.

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Policy Objectives

This document seeks to enhance institutional capacity for OER, Open Resources, promote transparency in decision-making, and ensure that resources committed to related initiatives are used effectively.

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Scope

Applicable across the full range of institutions governed by Technical Education, the document addresses planning, delivery, resourcing and evaluation, and may be supplemented by operational guidance issued subsequently.

The provisions apply to all universities and colleges under Technical Education. Sector partners, including employers and professional bodies, are expected to support implementation within their respective spheres.

Key Provisions

The document mandates periodic self-assessment against OER, disclosure of material information to Technical Education, and corrective action where institutional performance falls short of the stated expectations.

Institutions are required to integrate OER, Open Resources into annual planning cycles, designate accountable officers, and maintain records demonstrating compliance with the expectations set out here.

Implementation Pathway

Implementation will proceed through phased institutional adoption, supported by professional development, shared guidance and a common reporting calendar established by Technical Education.

A dedicated implementation pathway, covering readiness assessment, capacity building and progressive rollout, has been designed to allow institutions of varying size and maturity to comply.

Accountability Framework

Heads of institutions bear overall responsibility for embedding OER, supported by designated coordinators, academic bodies and administrative units within each institution.

Technical Education provides policy direction, capacity support and performance oversight, while institutions translate the framework into operational practice and maintain day-to-day accountability.

Monitoring Arrangements

Progress will be monitored through annual institutional returns, targeted reviews and outcome indicators maintained centrally by Technical Education. Findings will inform guidance and, where necessary, corrective measures.

Closing Note

Effective implementation of Open Educational Resources Policy will depend on sustained institutional commitment and close coordination between Technical Education and the sector. Institutions are encouraged to embed the arrangements described here into their normal planning and review cycles.